

Ick or Imagination?

AI Sentiment in women's media

An analysis of long form YouTube videos
and comments centred around women,
across the timeline of the AI boom.

Karina Khan



The Stepford AI Issue

Studies show that women adopt AI at rates 25% lower than men.

Call it the "ick," but some claim the difference is rooted in how AI systems are designed with feminized personas that perform submissiveness (Awomosu, 2026). This project investigates how women's media frames artificial intelligence throughout the AI boom.

The central research question asks:

What is the sentiment of artificial intelligence in long-form YouTube videos and comments centered around women, from 2022-2026? And how does this sentiment vary across domains?

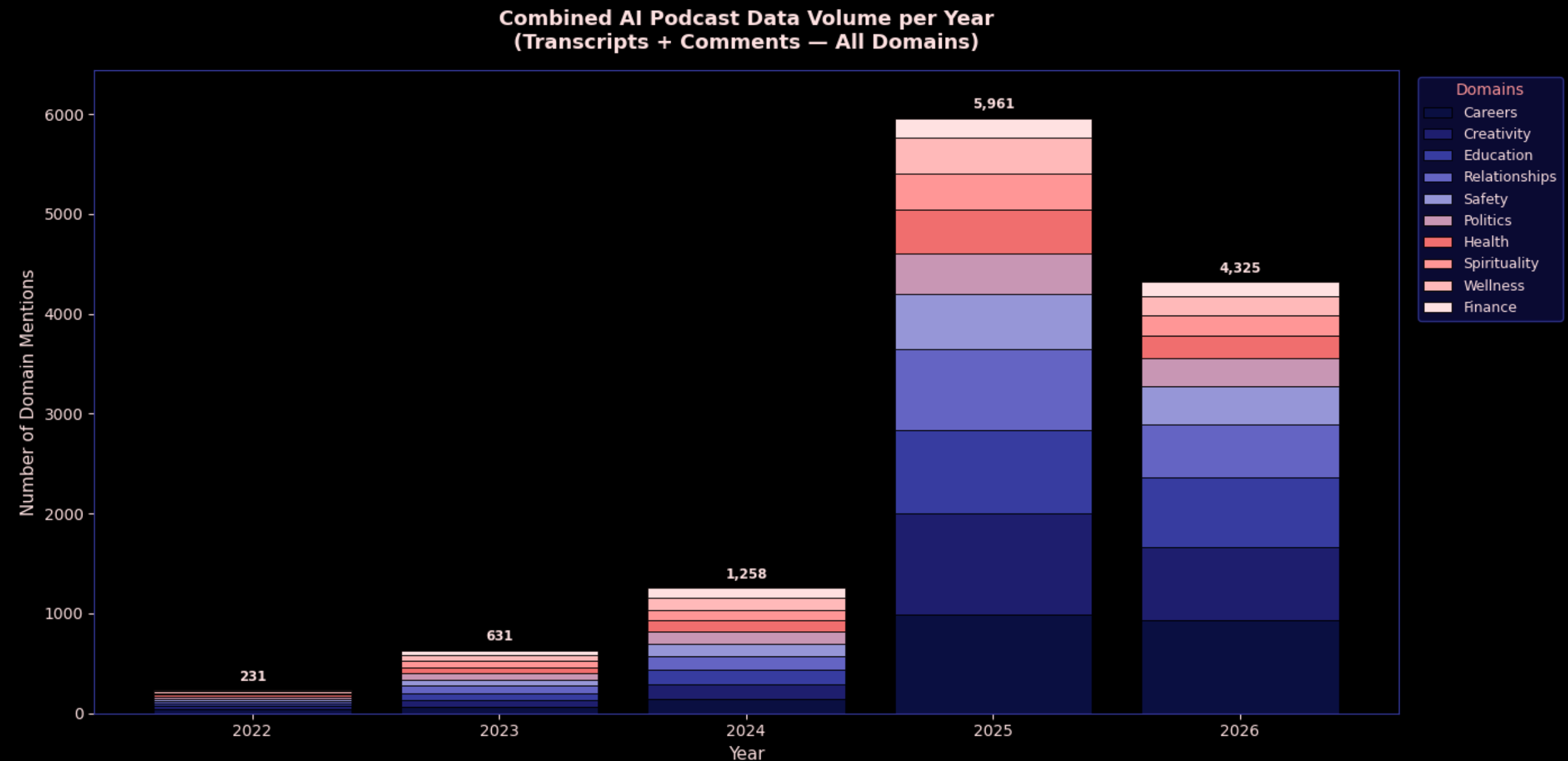


Data sources

Source	Purpose	Approach
YouTube Data API	Used this API to produce a primary dataset of 400+ long form YouTube videos with my queries.	<code>search.list</code> queries by keyword/year, enriched via batched <code>videos.list</code> calls to get full metadata (view count, duration, etc.)
YouTube Data API	Used this API to collect the top 100 most relevant comments from each of the videos in the primary dataset.	<code>commentThreads.list</code> called per video, sorted by relevance, capped at top 100 comments per video
yt-dlp	Used this command line tool as a fallback method to capture raw transcript text from the videos in the primary dataset.	called via Python's <code>subprocess.run()</code> , fetching auto-generated or manual English subtitles in json3 format, then tokenized via NLTK's <code>sent_tokenize()</code>

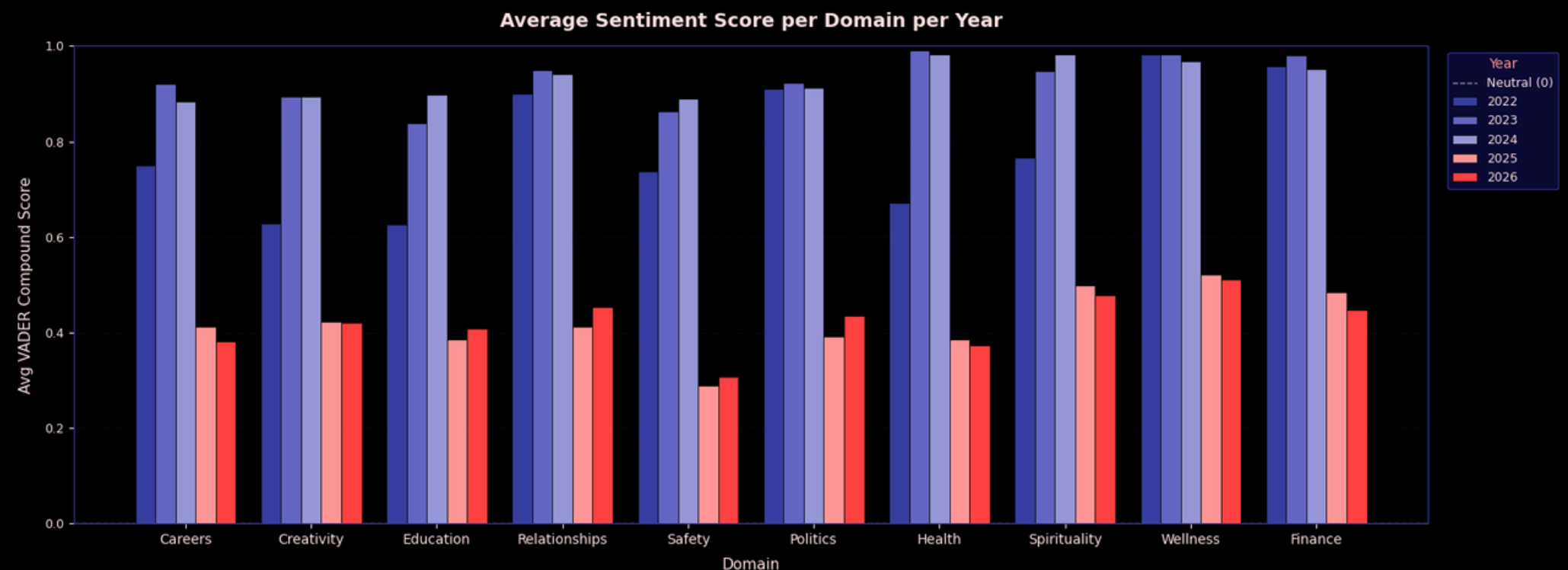
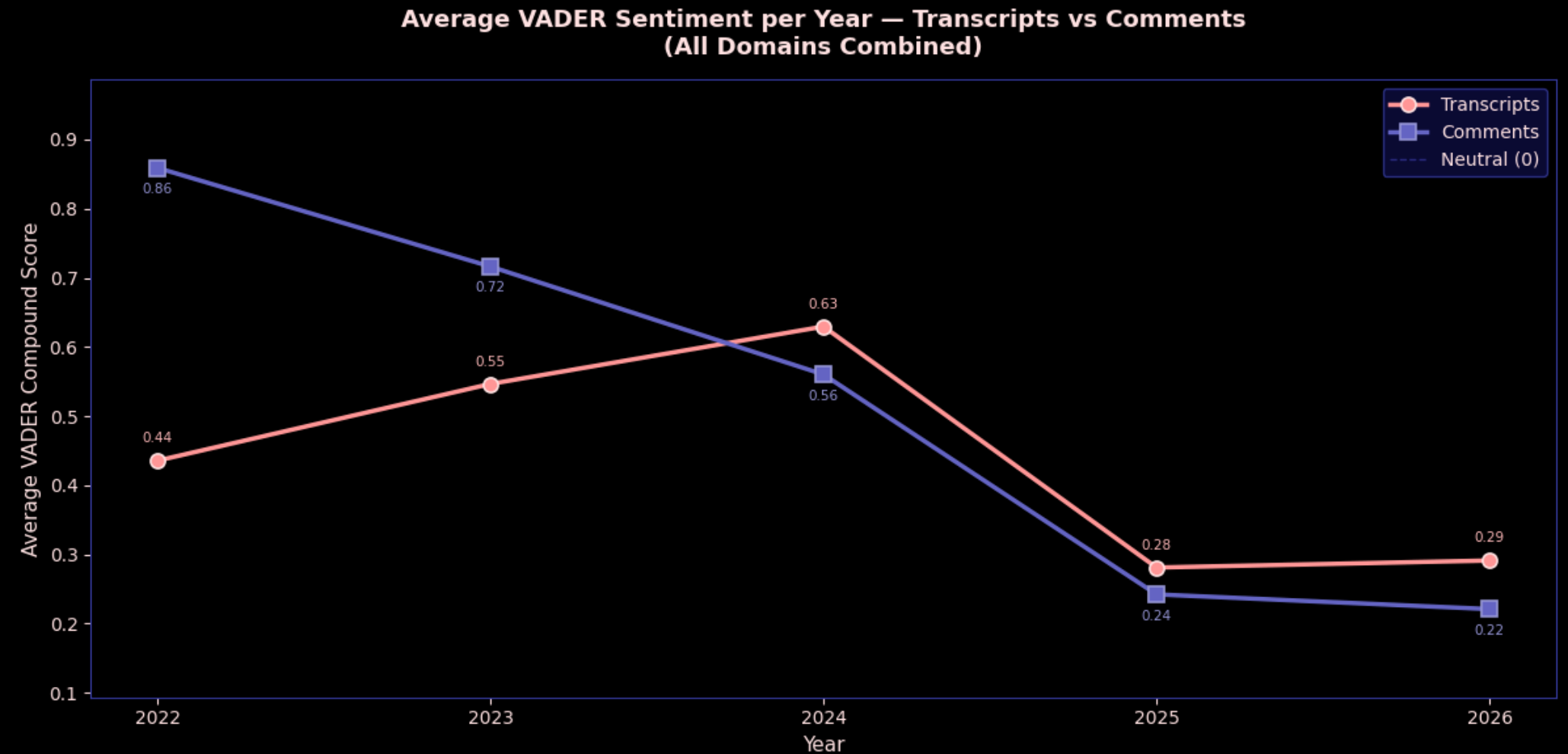
At a glance

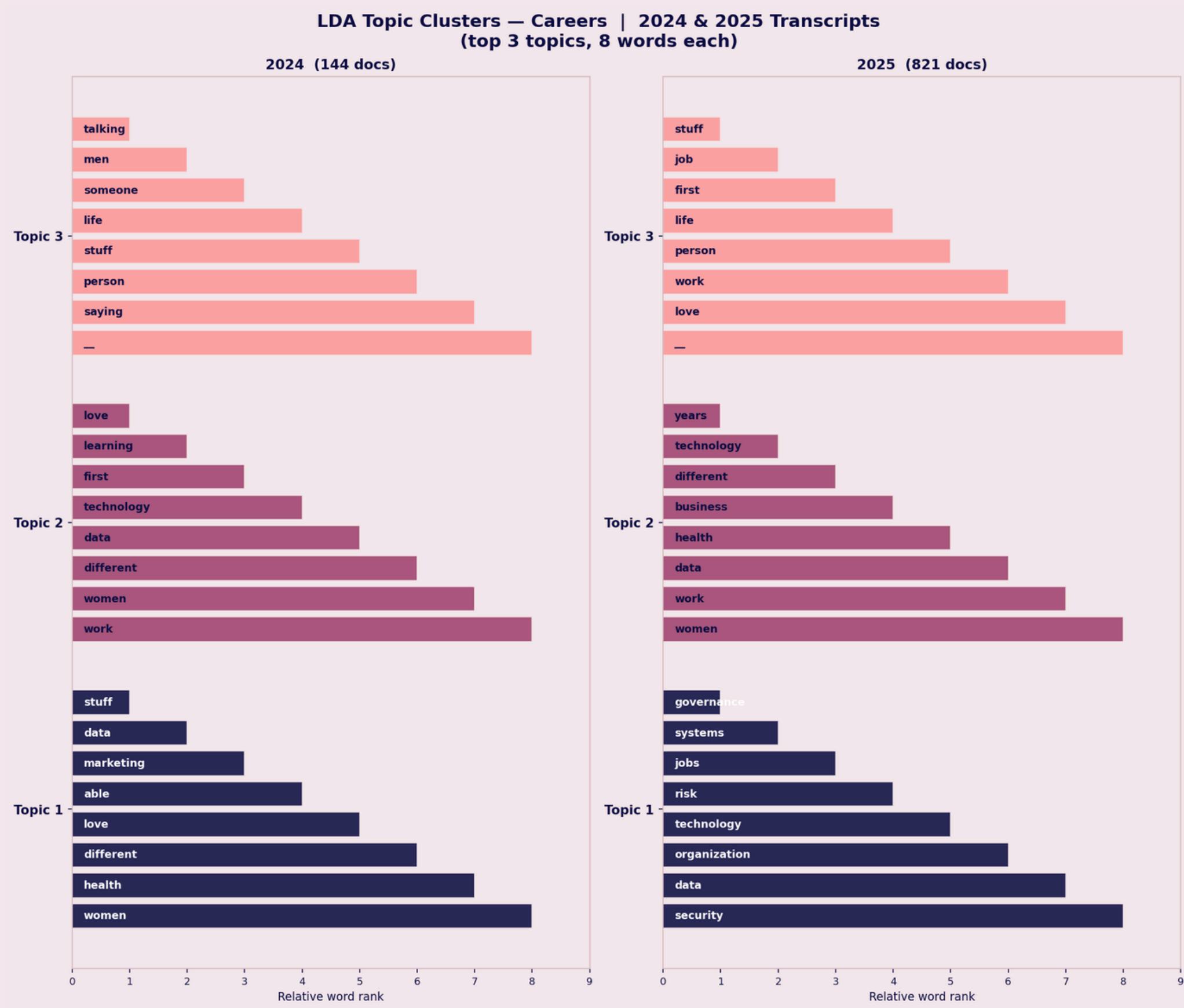
- The amount of transcript and comment data that incorporates my search queries increased significantly after 2024
- Women's careers, creativity and education are the leading domains of discussion across YouTube transcript and comment data



Sentiment across domains

- Average sentiment across comments declines over time
- Average sentiment in transcripts across transcripts increases leading up to 2024, then declines in 2025
- Collectively, all domains experience a significant decrease in average sentiment score after 2024
- Conversations around relationships experience the greatest drop in sentiment from 2024-25

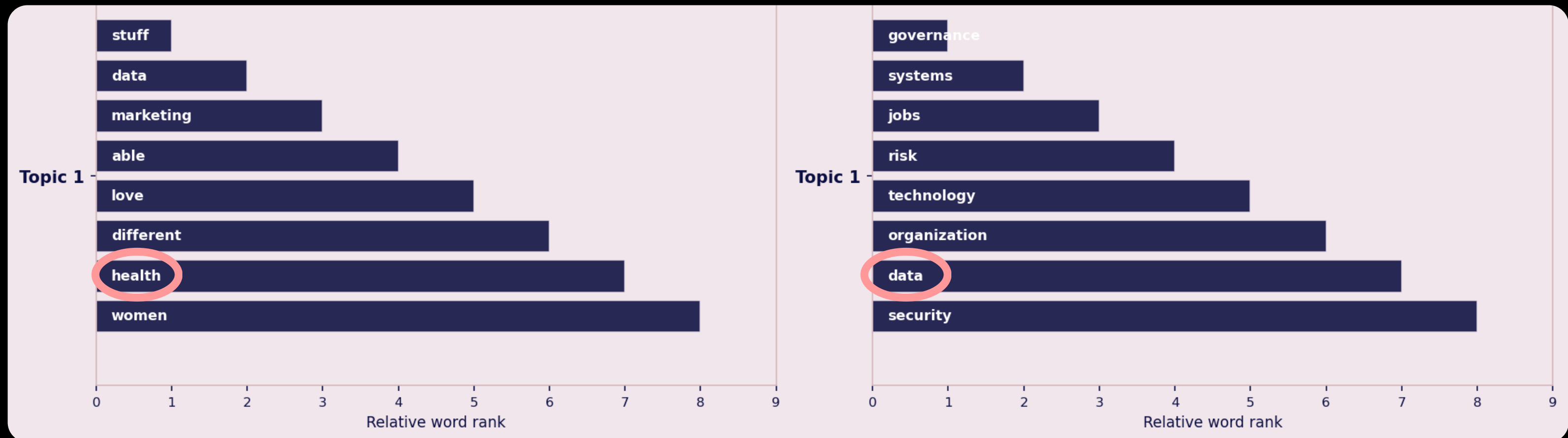




A shift in framing

- Top 2024 topics are dominated by relational words like *women, love, different*
- By 2025, Topic 1 in transcripts reflects structural language like *system, organization, security*
- 2025 Topic 1 cluster reflect cybersecurity and AI governance as growing fields rather than job security fears
- *Health* in Topic 1 is almost entirely driven by a cohort of podcasts that explicitly discuss health and wellness tech as a career path or product area
- 2025 shifts toward institutional and structural framing

2024 vs. 2025 women-AI-career-content



- "If you look at the data for **health**, there's a big gap between men and women..."
- "it uses AI for good to drive better **health** outcomes and also provide women and doctors with insights to make better **health** decisions"
- "people are questioning whether AI is ready to give people **health** recommendations"

- "we are looking to launch this **data** analytics and AI class"
- "creating AI which will structure unstructured medical **data** in a way no one's been able to do before"
- "how can AI and **data** help close the gaps in women's health innovation?"
- "AI is only as good as the **data** behind it...what this means for women trying to advocate for themselves"

Challenges

- Original research question couldn't truly be answered:
 - Gender could not be identified
 - VADER measures positive/negative sentiment, but my research question was originally about fear vs. possibility narratives
 - Original question: *What specific AI use cases do women imagine for themselves across the 2022–2026 AI boom?*
- Bypassing IP blocks to access the YouTube transcripts (video coverage gap)
- YouTube API quota limits
- Domain overlap (data can span multiple categories)